

The Estate & Local Sikkim

What is on the property, what is worth doing nearby, what the weather does month by month, and what to bring.

The Estate

Three rooms, a restaurant, a pool, a spa and about four acres of terraced garden on a south-facing ridge above Gangtok. The buildings are glass and local stone, set into the slope rather than on top of it, and every room faces the mountains.

What you will find here

- **High-speed Starlink Wi-Fi** in every room and public space.
- **In-room dining** around the clock, from the full menu until 10:30 PM.
- **24/7 front desk and concierge**, reachable on WhatsApp at any hour.
- **Secure valet parking**, complimentary, on site.
- **Premium minibar** with organic Temi teas, restocked daily.
- **Fitness centre and yoga studio**, open early to late.
- **Private estate gardens** — terraces, herb beds and walking paths.
- **Smart climate control** with heating, cooling and heated floors.

The three signature experiences

The Himalayan Infinity Pool — temperature-controlled, open to the Kanchenjunga range. **The Glasshouse Restaurant** — Sikkimese and global cooking inside glass walls that open onto the valley. **The traditional hot stone spa** — authentic Dotsho healing baths with herbs foraged on the estate.

The gardens

Four terraces of herbs, greens and old rhododendron, with a 20-minute circular path and a bench at the lower corner that catches the last light. The kitchen picks here daily and will happily walk you round before dinner if you ask.

Gangtok in a Day

Ten minutes away and worth at least an afternoon. The concierge will arrange a car and, if you want one, a guide at ₹2,500 for half a day.

Place	Distance	Why go
MG Marg	2 km · 10 min	Pedestrian boulevard, cafés, tea houses, handicrafts
Banjhakri Falls	7 km · 25 min	100 ft waterfall in a landscaped energy park
Tashi Viewpoint	8 km · 20 min	The classic Kanchenjunga sunrise vantage
Ganesh Tok and Hanuman Tok	6 km · 20 min	Small hilltop temples, big views
Enchey Monastery	4 km · 15 min	200-year-old Nyingma monastery, quiet mornings
Namgyal Institute of Tibetology	3 km · 12 min	Serious collection of thangkas and manuscripts
Flower Exhibition Centre	3 km · 12 min	Orchids under glass; best March to May
Ropeway, Deorali–Tashiling	3 km · 12 min	₹120, ten minutes, the whole town below you

A good afternoon

Ropeway up, walk down to MG Marg, tea at one of the older houses, an hour in the handicraft emporium, then Tashi Viewpoint for last light — back for dinner by eight.

MG Marg is closed to vehicles and is spotless: Sikkim banned single-use plastic bags in 1998, long before it was fashionable, and fines litter seriously.

Day Trips: Lakes, Passes and Monasteries

Destination	Distance	Permit	Notes
Tsomgo Lake	38 km · ~2 hrs	ILP / PAP	Glacial lake at 12,400 ft; frozen in winter
Nathula Pass	54 km · ~3 hrs	ILP, Indians only	Old Silk Route border at 14,140 ft
Rumtek Monastery	24 km · ~1 hr	None	Largest in Sikkim, seat of the Karmapa
Baba Harbhajan Mandir	52 km · ~3 hrs	ILP	Usually combined with Tsomgo
Zuluk, Old Silk Route	95 km · ~5 hrs	ILP	The switchback road; best as an overnight

Tsomgo and Nathula, honestly

This is the great day out from Gangtok and it is also a long, cold, high day. You leave at 6:00 AM, you spend two hours climbing to 12,400 ft, and you will feel it. Take it slowly, drink water, and turn back without embarrassment if you get a headache that will not shift. The lake is genuinely beautiful and the yaks are genuinely there.

- Dress for 0°C even in May. Jackets and boots can be hired at the roadside for about ₹300.
- Nathula opens Wednesday to Sunday, weather permitting, and closes with no notice for snow.
- There is no reliable mobile signal past Kyongnosla.
- Guests with cardiac or respiratory conditions, and pregnant guests, should not go above Tsomgo.

Rumtek

An hour away and a complete change of register — the golden stupa, the murals, and a wide quiet valley view. Go on a weekday morning. Carry photo ID; there is a security check at the gate.

The Year, Month by Month

Month	Day / night	Weather	What it is good for
Jan – Feb	12° / 2°C	Cold, dry, very clear	Empty town, sharpest mountain views, snow above 3,000 m
Mar – Apr	18° / 8°C	Warming, mostly clear	Rhododendron and orchid season; the loveliest month is April
May	22° / 13°C	Warm, building cloud	Green, long days, before the rain
Jun – Aug	23° / 17°C	Monsoon, heavy rain	Waterfalls, mist, solitude, lowest travel costs, road risk
Sep	22° / 15°C	Clearing	The rain ends, the air is washed, prices are still low
Oct – Nov	20° / 10°C	Dry, brilliant	The best of the year — Kanchenjunga out most mornings
Dec	15° / 5°C	Cold, clear	Festive, crisp, short days

Festivals worth planning around

- **Losar** (Feb/Mar) — Tibetan New Year; monastery dances.
- **Saga Dawa** (May/Jun) — the holiest Buddhist month; processions in Gangtok.
- **Pang Lhabsol** (Aug/Sep) — Sikkim's own festival honouring Kanchenjunga, with masked Chaam dances.
- **Dasain and Tihar** (Oct/Nov) — the Nepali festivals; the town is lit and half of it is on holiday.
- **Losoong** (Dec) — Sikkimese new year, archery and dances.

During major festivals shops and offices close for a day or two, permit offices included. Plan excursions around them.

What to Bring

The estate supplies robes, slippers, umbrellas, adaptors and toiletries. What follows is what guests most often wish they had packed.

All year

- Shoes with grip. Every path here is stone and every stone is occasionally wet.
- A warm layer for the evening, even in June — it drops 8–10°C after dark.
- Sunscreen and sunglasses. UV at 1,650 m is stronger than the temperature suggests.
- Any prescription medication in its original packaging, with enough for the whole trip.
- A power bank for excursion days; there is no charging at Tsomgo.

Monsoon, June to September

- A proper rain shell, not a fashion one, and a dry bag for a camera.
- Quick-dry trousers; cotton stays wet for days in this humidity.
- Leech socks if you plan to walk in the forest. They are harmless and unpleasant.
- Two extra days of flexibility in your itinerary, for the road.

Winter and high excursions

- Thermals, a down layer, gloves and a hat if you are going above 3,000 m. Hire is available at the roadside but the fit is a lottery.
- Lip balm and moisturiser — the air is very dry in January.

Sikkim is a plastic-free state. Bring a reusable bottle; we refill it with filtered water free, everywhere on the estate.